

RESQNET - ANIMAL HANDLING IN CRISES

Safety protocols for volunteers assisting frightened, distressed, or potentially aggressive animals.

1. MAKE THE SCENE SAFE

- Check for immediate hazards and keep bystanders at a safe distance; do not enter an unsafe area.
- Ask the owner or responsible handler about the animal's name, triggers, health needs, and usual handling.
- Approach slowly and calmly from the side; avoid sudden movements, direct staring, crowding, or cornering.
- Use a trained animal handler for an animal showing distress, pain, defensive behavior, or aggression.

2. HANDLE AND TRANSPORT CAREFULLY

- Use appropriate, secure equipment only when trained and when it can be applied without increasing danger.
- Never restrain, lift, separate, or muzzle an animal beyond your training or available equipment.
- Keep animals separated when needed and away from noise, crowds, hazards, and unfamiliar animals.
- Use a secured, ventilated carrier or approved transport method; never leave an animal in a hot vehicle.

3. PROVIDE CARE AND HAND OVER

- Follow the shelter or veterinary lead's instructions for water, food, medication, and designated animal areas.
- Record identifying details, owner or handler contact, location, observed condition, and transfer destination.
- Report bites, scratches, escapes, injuries, or signs of illness promptly; do not diagnose or treat beyond training.
- For a bite or scratch, move to safety, wash the area with soap and water, and seek medical advice promptly.

IMPORTANT

Human safety comes first. Do not approach or handle an animal when it is unsafe; call the designated animal-response professional.